

SME South Africa — Phase 1 SEO Implementation Briefs

Prepared: May 2026 | **Based on:** 12-month GSC data (Jun 2025–May 2026) + Orphan audit
For: Editor + Developer implementation | **Stack:** WordPress / Yoast SEO Premium / Link Whisper / Tshepho's Ops

Critical Context Before You Start

The GSC data reveals a consistent pattern across the site: **multiple pages competing for the same queries**. This is the primary reason key pages are stuck at positions 18–22 despite high impression volumes. The fix is consolidation and depth — not new content.

Three rules for this phase:

1. Merge before you create. Every new page must displace an existing weak page (via 301 redirect), not sit alongside it.
 2. Update all publish/modified dates after each refresh — Yoast and GSC both reward freshness signals.
 3. After each redirect, submit the new canonical URL in Google Search Console → URL Inspection → Request Indexing.
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Overview: Impact Estimates at a Glance

Brief	Action	Current clicks/month	Est. clicks at target position
1 — Registration Hub	Consolidate 2 articles + outrank forum thread	~1,400	~12,000–18,000
2 — /sme-funding/ Hub	Consolidate 3 funding pages, refresh category	~3,900	~15,000–22,000
3 — Franchise Refresh	Deepen content, move pos 16 → pos 6–8	~15,700	~20,000–25,000
4 — NPO Funding Refresh	Refresh, move pos 19 → pos 5–8	~6,800	~18,000–24,000
5 — Off-Brand Cleanup	Takealot consolidation, Paxi rewrite, noindex	~3,100	Signal recovery

Estimates based on GSC impression volumes × benchmark CTR at target positions. Not guaranteed.

Brief 1 — Business Registration Hub: Consolidation + Refresh

Priority: CRITICAL | Type: Consolidation + Content refresh | Est. effort: 1 day editor + 30 mins dev

Current state (GSC evidence)

Three pages and one forum thread are all competing for the same registration queries, splitting link equity and confusing Google's ranking signals:

URL	Impressions	Clicks	CTR	Position
[forum] How_do_I_register_my_business_in_South_Africa	870,479	1,534	0.18%	10.79
/the-basics-of-how-to-register-a-small-business-in-south-africa/	247,538	1,228	0.50%	18.09
/faqs-about-registering-a-company-in-south-africa/	98,144	188	0.19%	18.56

Target queries driving impressions:

- "how to register a company" — 45,854 imp, 0.21% CTR, pos 7.85
- "how to register a company in south africa" — 22,338 imp, 0.29% CTR, pos 8.19
- "how to register a business" — 20,726 imp, 0.47% CTR, pos 7.56
- "how to register a business in south africa" — 14,762 imp, 0.65% CTR, pos 7.34
- "cipc" — 16,128 imp, 0.26% CTR, pos 5.69

Problem diagnosis

The forum thread ranks at pos 10.79 (the best position) because it has accumulated engagement signals over time. But forum threads convert at 0.18% CTR because users want an article, not a discussion. The two articles are at pos 18 because Google cannot decide which is canonical — they're competing, not reinforcing each other.

Action plan

Step 1 — Choose canonical URL (Developer) Keep: /the-basics-of-how-to-register-a-small-business-in-south-africa/

(Higher traffic, more equity than the FAQ page. Verbose URL is not ideal but changing it adds redirect complexity — defer URL cleanup to a later phase.)

Step 2 — Redirect (Developer) /faqs-about-registering-a-company-in-south-africa/ → 301 → /the-basics-of-how-to-register-a-small-business-in-south-africa/

Step 3 — Full content rewrite of the canonical article (Editor) Merge the best content from both articles into one comprehensive guide using the structure below. Target: **2,800–3,500 words**.

Step 4 — Forum thread (Developer/Moderator) In the BuddyBoss forum thread "How do I register my business in South Africa," add a pinned mod note at the top: *"For a complete step-by-step guide, see: [How to Register a Company in South Africa — Full CIPC Guide] (link to canonical article)."* Do NOT redirect the forum thread — that would break the community experience. The link will pass some equity and reduce the CTR penalty from Google seeing a forum URL for this query.

Content specification: /the-basics-of-how-to-register-a-small-business-in-south-africa/

Target publication date: Within 2 weeks of this brief

Word count: 2,800–3,500 words

Authorship: Attribute to a named author with business/legal background. Add an author bio box if not present — this is an E-E-A-T signal.

Freshness: Add "Last updated: [Month Year]" visibly below the title. Update this every time the article is refreshed.

Yoast settings:

- SEO Title: (How to Register a Company in South Africa (2026 CIPC Guide) | SME South Africa)
- Meta description (under 160 chars): (Step-by-step guide to registering a company in South Africa via CIPC BizPortal. Includes costs, documents, timelines, and what to do after registration.)
- Focus keyphrase: (how to register a company in south africa)
- Secondary keyphrases (Yoast Premium): (how to register a business in south africa), (CIPC company registration), (how to register a small business south africa)
- Cornerstone content: ON
- Internal links: Add using Link Suggester during editing

Schema (via Yoast):

- Article schema: already applied by default
 - Add HowTo schema: mark each numbered step (BizPortal steps) with HowTo schema to target rich results
 - Add FAQ schema: mark the FAQ section
-

Full H1/H2/H3 outline:

H1: How to Register a Company in South Africa (2026 Step-by-Step Guide)

[Intro – 150 words]

Who this guide is for. What registering your company unlocks: bank account, SARS tax compliance, government tenders, B-BBEE certificate, funding applications. Note: costs R175, takes 1-3 days.

H2: Which Business Structure Should You Register?

H3: Private Company (Pty) Ltd – for most SMEs

H3: Non-Profit Company (NPC)

H3: Sole Proprietor / Informal Business

H3: Close Corporation (CC) – legacy only; no new CCs since 2011

[Table comparing structures: liability, tax, cost, registration requirement]

H2: What Documents and Information Do You Need?

[Checklist format – good for featured snippet and on-page UX]

- SA ID/passport for all directors
- Proof of address for each director
- Chosen company name (or use registration number as name)
- Memorandum of Incorporation (CIPC provides standard template)

H2: How to Register via BizPortal (Recommended Method)

[Introductory sentence: BizPortal is CIPC's recommended online portal for SA ID holders.

It integrates with major banks for simultaneous business account opening.]

H3: Step 1 – Reserve Your Company Name (Optional, R50)

[Search Google + CIPC database first. Avoid generic names. Can skip and use registration number as trading name – saves R50.]

H3: Step 2 – Create Your BizPortal Account

[Visit bizportal.gov.za – requires SA ID number. System links to Home Affairs for verification.]

H3: Step 3 – Complete the Registration Forms (CoR14.1)

[Director details, registered address, share structure for Pty Ltd.]

H3: Step 4 – Pay the Registration Fee

[R175 total. Payable online via card or EFT.]

H3: Step 5 – Download Your CoR14.3 Certificate

[Usually received within 1-3 business days via email. This is your proof of registration.]

H2: Alternative Method: CIPC e-Services

[Briefly explain – same outcome, slightly more technical. Recommend BizPortal for first-time registrations.]

H2: What to Do Immediately After Registration (Don't Skip This)

[This section is the key differentiator – most articles stop at step 5. This section serves post-registration intent and creates internal linking opportunities to funding and tax content.]

H3: Register for Tax with SARS (Within 60 Days)

[Register for income tax on SARS eFiling. Register for PAYE if hiring staff.

As of 1 April 2026, VAT registration is only compulsory if turnover exceeds R2.3 million –

updated threshold from Budget 2026. Turnover Tax is optional for businesses under R2.3m turnover.

[Internal link → SARS/tax article when built]]

H3: Get Your B-BBEE Certificate (Free for EMEs)

[If turnover is under R10 million, you qualify as an Exempt Micro Enterprise (EME).

Get a free B-BBEE certificate via CIPC or complete a sworn affidavit from a Commissioner of Oaths.

Required for government tenders and many supplier applications.

[Internal link → B-BBEE explainer when built]]

H3: Open a Business Bank Account

[List 3–4 major SA business banks with basic account options. BizPortal integrates

with Absa, FNB, Nedbank, Standard Bank for same-day account opening.]

H3: Register for UIF (If Employing Staff)

[Employer registration at uFiling.co.za]

H3: Apply for Funding (Now That You Have a Registration Number)

[Registration number is required for all government funding applications.

[Internal link → /sme-funding/ hub + /seda-grant-funding/ + /sme-guides/guide-to-nyda-funding/]]

H2: How Much Does It Cost to Register a Company in South Africa?

[Simple table: name reservation R50 (optional), registration R125, total R175. One of the most affordable formal registrations globally.]

H2: How Long Does Company Registration Take?

[Online via BizPortal: 1–3 business days. Manual: 5–10 business days.

Same-day possible via approved registration service providers (additional cost).]

H2: Common Mistakes to Avoid

[5-6 bullet points: not checking name availability first, using personal address as registered address when renting, not updating directors on CIPC after changes, missing SARS registration deadline, not renewing annual returns (costs R250-R550/year via CIPC).]

H2: Frequently Asked Questions

[Mark with FAQ schema in Yoast]

Q: Can a foreign national register a company in South Africa?

A: Yes, with a valid passport, but cannot use BizPortal – must use CIPC e-services or a registration service provider.

Q: Do I need a lawyer or accountant to register?

A: No. CIPC BizPortal is designed for self-service. A consultant is optional.

Q: What is the difference between CIPC e-services and BizPortal?

A: Same outcome; BizPortal is faster, integrates with banks, recommended for SA ID holders.

Q: Can I register without a physical office address?

A: You need a valid SA address. A home address is acceptable – it just becomes your registered address on public record.

Q: When do I need to register for VAT?

A: Only when annual turnover exceeds R2.3 million (from 1 April 2026, Budget 2026 change).

Q: What happens if I don't renew my annual returns?

A: CIPC can deregister your company. Annual returns are due on the anniversary of registration – costs R250-R550 depending on turnover.

Internal links to add

Outbound from this article (add during editing via Link Suggester):

- → /sme-funding/ (anchor: "funding applications")
- → /seda-grant-funding/ (anchor: "SEDA funding")
- → /sme-guides/guide-to-nyda-funding/ (anchor: "NYDA")
- → /register-with-the-national-credit-regulator-ncr/ (anchor: "NCR registration" if applicable to business type)

- → Business Plan orphan post (anchor: "business plan") — [Link Architect task]
- → B-BBEE guide (anchor: "B-BBEE certificate") — once published

Inbound links TO this article from (add manually or via Link Architect):

- /sme-funding/ hub page
- /seda-grant-funding/ (add a "Before you apply" note with link)
- /sme-guides/guide-to-nyda-funding/ (same)
- /non-profit-organisation-npo-funding/ (for NPOs needing to register first)
- The 4-5 orphan guide posts in the registration/advice cluster

Success metrics (check after 60-90 days)

- Target position: 5-10 for "how to register a company in south africa"
- CTR target: 3-5% (up from 0.5%)
- Click target: 5,000-10,000/month (up from ~1,200)

Brief 2 — /sme-funding/ Funding Hub Fix

Priority: CRITICAL | Type: Category page optimisation + spoke consolidation | Est. effort: 1 day editor + 1 hour dev

Current state

The funding section has severe page fragmentation — three URLs targeting almost identical queries:

URL	Impressions	Clicks	CTR	Position
/sme-funding/	535,876	3,883	0.72%	22.33
/guide-government-funding-small-businesses/	301,930	1,585	0.52%	19.68
/sme-guides/guide-to-government-funding-for-small-businesses/	101,612	692	0.68%	30.06
[forum] Getting_Funding	193,209	339	0.18%	13.37

Strong spoke pages already working (do not touch):

- /seda-grant-funding/: 285K imp, 7,106 clicks, 2.5% CTR, pos 8.91 
- /sme-guides/guide-to-nyda-funding/: 247K imp, 1,382 clicks, pos 8.54 
- /understanding-nyda-funding-requirements/: 134K imp, 1,948 clicks, pos 8.38 

- /non-profit-organisation-npo-funding/: 246K imp, 6,776 clicks, pos 19.07 (needs refresh — see Brief 4)

Problem diagnosis

</sme-funding/> has child pages (</sme-funding/working-capital-loans/>), (</sme-funding/unsecured-loans/>), (</sme-funding/bridging-finance/>) — this is a **WordPress category archive page**, not a regular post. Category archive pages are notoriously thin on content because they just list posts. Google's ranking signals treat them as low-quality unless rich editorial content is added.

Additionally, two separate articles (</guide-government-funding-small-businesses/>) and (</sme-guides/guide-to-government-funding-for-small-businesses/>) directly compete with each other and with the hub, splitting equity three ways. All three pages sit at positions 19–30.

Action plan

Step 1 — Consolidate the two government funding articles (Developer + Editor)

Keep: </guide-government-funding-small-businesses/>

Redirect: </sme-guides/guide-to-government-funding-for-small-businesses/> → 301 → </guide-government-funding-small-businesses/>

Refresh the kept article — target 2,200–2,800 words — using the outline below.

Step 2 — Enrich the /sme-funding/ category hub (Editor + Developer)

In WordPress, go to: **Posts → Categories → SME Funding → Edit**

Add a rich category description (Yoast's SEO section on the category edit screen). This text appears above the post list on the archive page and is the primary on-page content Google uses to evaluate category pages.

Content specification: </guide-government-funding-small-businesses/>

Yoast settings:

- SEO Title: [Government Funding for Small Businesses in South Africa \(2026 Guide\)](#) | [SME South Africa](#)
- Meta description: [Full list of government funding and grants available to South African small businesses in 2026. SEDA, NYDA, NEF, SEFA, DTI and more — with requirements and how to apply.](#)
- Focus keyphrase: [government funding for small business south africa](#)
- Secondary keyphrases: [small business funding south africa](#), [small business grants south africa](#), [non repayable grants for small business](#)
- Cornerstone content: **ON**

H1/H2 outline:

H1: Government Funding for Small Businesses in South Africa (2026 Complete Guide)

[Intro – 200 words]

Overview of the SA government funding landscape. Key point: most government funding

is not a grant – it's a loan, equity stake, or support programme. True non-repayable

grants exist but are competitive. This guide lists what's available and who qualifies.

[Internal link → /non-repayable-small-business-grants page if exists, or mention the

non-repayable grants section below]

H2: Non-Repayable Grants (True Grants – No Repayment Required)

[This addresses the top-performing query: "non repayable small business grants south africa"]

- 21K impressions, 5.45% CTR. Explicitly use the term in the subheading.]
- DTI/DTIC programmes (Black Industrialists, Agro-Processing)
- SETA grants for staff training
- Provincial grants (mention top provinces)
- Sector-specific grants

H2: Government Development Finance Institutions (Loans + Equity)

H3: SEDA – Small Enterprise Development Agency

[Summary + requirements + link → /seda-grant-funding/]

H3: NYDA – National Youth Development Agency

[For entrepreneurs aged 18–35. Summary + requirements + link → /sme-guides/guide-to-nyda-funding/]

H3: SEFA – Small Enterprise Finance Agency

[loans from R10,000 to R15 million]

H3: NEF – National Empowerment Fund

[Black-owned businesses, equity finance and loans]

H3: IDC – Industrial Development Corporation

[Larger businesses, R1m+]

H2: How to Qualify: Common Requirements Across All Government Funders

[Bullet list – serves the "requirements" query intent]

- Registered company (CIPC) + [internal link → registration hub]
- Tax compliance certificate (SARS)
- B-BBEE certificate or EME affidavit
- 3–6 months bank statements
- Business plan with financial projections
- CIPC annual returns up to date

H2: What to Prepare Before Applying

[Checklist format – featured snippet target]

H2: Common Reasons Applications Are Rejected

[Addresses "reasons why business needs funding" queries – 13% CTR query]

H2: Private and Alternative Funding Options

[Brief section – purchase order funding, working capital loans – with internal links

to [/sme-funding/working-capital-loans/](#) and [/sme-funding/unsecured-loans/](#)]

H2: Frequently Asked Questions

Q: What is the easiest government grant to get in South Africa?

Q: Can a sole proprietor apply for government funding?

Q: What is the difference between SEDA, NYDA, SEFA and NEF?

Q: Do I need a business plan to apply for funding?

[/sme-funding/](#) category page — SEO description to add

Go to: **WordPress → Posts → Categories → edit the "SME Funding" or "Business Funding" category → Yoast SEO tab**

Add the following to the Yoast category description field (this renders as rich content on the [/sme-funding/](#) archive page):

Category SEO Title: [Business Funding for SMEs in South Africa | SME South Africa](#)

Category Meta Description: [Find funding for your South African small business.](#)

[Guides to government grants, development finance, working capital loans, SEDA, NYDA, and more.](#)

Category description text (200–300 words): Write an editorial intro covering: what types of funding are available in SA, who the main government funders are, a note on eligibility basics, and links to the top guides in this category. This replaces the default empty archive header and gives Google something to evaluate.

Forum thread — Getting_Funding (193K impressions)

Add a pinned moderator comment: *"Looking for a full list of government funding options? Start with our complete guide: [\[Government Funding for Small Businesses in South Africa\]](#) (link to [/guide-government-funding-small-businesses/](#))."*

Internal links to add

- → [/seda-grant-funding/](#) (multiple anchor contexts)
- → [/sme-guides/guide-to-nyda-funding/](#)
- → [/non-profit-organisation-npo-funding/](#) (for NPO-specific funding)

- → /the-basics-of-how-to-register-a-small-business-in-south-africa/ (registration is a prerequisite)
- → "Black Business Suppliers Grant" orphan post (Link Architect task)
- → "Focus on The Black Business Suppliers Grant" orphan (if content is still accurate — if outdated, prune)

Success metrics (60–90 days)

- /guide-government-funding-small-businesses/ target position: 5–10
- /sme-funding/ category page target position: 10–15
- Combined click target: 15,000–22,000/month

Brief 3 — /10-cheapest-franchises-in-south-africa/ Refresh

Priority: HIGH | Type: Content deepening + schema | Est. effort: 0.5 days editor

Current state

URL	Impressions	Clicks	CTR	Position
/10-cheapest-franchises-in-south-africa/	323,386	15,738	4.87%	16.56

Top queries with exceptional CTR (already at pos 2–3):

- "cheapest franchise in south africa" — 4,268 imp, 23.2% CTR, pos 2.29  (hold)
- "franchise under r100 000 in south africa" — 5,587 imp, 20.2% CTR, pos 2.65  (hold)
- "cheap franchise in south africa" — 1,956 imp, 20.5% CTR, pos 2.60  (hold)

Additional franchise queries to target (currently ranking 6–14):

- "pedros franchise cost" — 11,233 imp, 1.01% CTR, pos 5.79
- "franchises in south africa" — 9,811 imp, 4.23% CTR, pos 6.16
- "kfc franchise cost in south africa" — 4,804 imp, 0.94% CTR, pos 9.72
- "postnet franchise cost" — 3,591 imp, 6.46% CTR, pos 6.00
- "franchise opportunities in south africa" — 3,456 imp, 6.28% CTR, pos 6.91

Problem diagnosis

The title/snippet is already compelling (20–23% CTR is exceptional), so the primary lever is **content depth and freshness** to lift average position from 16.56 to 6–10. The page likely lists 10 franchises with limited detail — Google wants comprehensive, decision-grade information including specific ZAR investment amounts, 2026 data, and individual franchise profiles.

Full content refresh — do NOT change URL or title tag. The title is clearly working based on CTR. Focus only on deepening the on-page content.

Yoast settings (update only):

- SEO Title: Keep current if it includes "cheapest" — confirm it reads naturally. Suggested: Cheapest Franchises in South Africa for 2026 (With Startup Costs) | SME South Africa
- Meta description: The most affordable franchise opportunities in South Africa for 2026. Startup costs, requirements and how to apply – from under R50,000 to under R500,000.
- Focus keyphrase: cheapest franchise in south africa
- Secondary: franchise under r100 000 in south africa, cheap franchise south africa

Content additions:

1. Add a sortable/filterable investment table near the top (featured snippet target):

Franchise	Sector	Est. Investment (ZAR)	Royalty %	FASA member?
Pedro's	QSR/Food	~R1.5m-R2.5m	Check current	Yes
PostNet	Business services	~R350k-R650k	Check current	Yes
Spaza/kiosk type	Retail	Under R100k	—	—
[10 entries total with 2026 figures]				

Note to editor: Verify all investment figures directly with FASA (Franchise Association of South Africa) or individual franchise disclosure documents before publishing. Do not publish estimated figures without SA-specific sourcing.

2. Add individual H2 sections for the 5-6 most-searched franchises including: Pedro's, PostNet, KFC (even if expensive — it ranks), affordable food franchises, sub-R100k options. Each section: brief overview, investment range, requirements, how to apply, and a link to the franchisor's official website.
3. Add FAQ schema section (Yoast):
 - "What is the cheapest franchise in South Africa?"

- "Can I buy a franchise for under R100,000?"
 - "Do I need prior experience to buy a franchise?"
 - "What is FASA and should I only consider FASA franchises?"
 - "How long before a franchise is profitable?"
4. **Update the "last updated" date** to current month.
 5. **Add author bio box** with a brief note on the author's business/franchise expertise.

Internal links to add

- From /top-10-most-successful-businesses-to-start-in-south-africa/ (533K impressions) → anchor: "franchise opportunities" → this article
- From /18-business-ideas-to-start-from-home/ → anchor: "franchise" or "established business model"
- From /business-ideas-in-south-africa/ equivalent pages
- This article → /sme-funding/ (anchor: "franchise financing") — many franchisees need funding

Success metrics (90 days)

- Target position: 6-10 (from 16.56)
- CTR target: maintain 5%+ at improved position
- Click target: 20,000-25,000/month (from 15,738)

Brief 4 — /non-profit-organisation-npo-funding/ Refresh

Priority: HIGH — QUICK WIN | Type: Content deepening + structure | Est. effort: 0.5 days editor

Current state

URL	Impressions	Clicks	CTR	Position
/non-profit-organisation-npo-funding/	245,778	6,776	2.76%	19.07

Target queries with very high CTR indicating strong intent:

- "list of npo funders in south africa" — 1,946 imp, **10.5% CTR**, pos 2.44 
- "npo funding in south africa" — 1,080 imp, **11.9% CTR**, pos 2.80 
- "funding for npo" — 1,078 imp, **14.5% CTR**, pos 4.20
- "donations for npo in south africa" — 1,012 imp, **10.2% CTR**, pos 3.01
- "npo funding" (broader) — substantial additional impressions

- "seta business funding" — 1,326 imp, **12.6% CTR**, pos 4.10

Problem diagnosis

The page already earns exceptional CTR (10-15%) on its top queries — meaning the title and snippet are compelling. The problem is average position 19.07, suggesting content depth is insufficient for the full query cluster, or there are competing pages diluting the signal. There is a second NPO page: /non-profit-organisation-compliance-the-ins-and-outs/ (8.6K imp) — this is different enough in topic that it shouldn't cause cannibalization.

The opportunity is significant: moving from pos 19 to pos 5-8 with current CTR levels could yield 18,000-24,000 clicks/month.

Action plan

Full content refresh — do NOT change URL.

Yoast settings:

- SEO Title: NPO Funding in South Africa: Full List of Funders & How to Apply (2026) | SME South Africa
- Meta description: Complete list of NPO funders in South Africa for 2026. Government grants, corporate donors, international foundations – with eligibility criteria and application steps.
- Focus keyword: npo funding south africa
- Secondary: list of npo funders in south africa, funding for npo south africa
- Cornerstone content: **ON**

Content structure (target 2,200-2,800 words):

H1: NPO Funding in South Africa: A Complete List of Funders for 2026

H2: Government Funding for NPOs

H3: DSD (Department of Social Development) – NPO registration + subsidies

H3: SASSA and social development grants

H3: LOTTO / National Lotteries Commission (NLC) – major grant funder

H3: Provincial government NPO funds (Gauteng, Western Cape, KZN)

H2: Corporate Social Investment (CSI) Funders

[List 10–15 major SA corporates that fund NPOs with application links]

H2: International Foundations Active in South Africa

[USAID, Ford Foundation, Aga Khan, etc.]

H2: How to Apply for NPO Funding: Step-by-Step Requirements

[This directly addresses the high-CTR "requirements" query intent]

H3: NPO registration with DSD (Section 21 company or NPC)

H3: What documents funders require

H3: How to write a fundable proposal

H2: Frequently Asked Questions

Q: What is the easiest NPO funding to get in South Africa?

Q: Do NPOs need to be CIPC-registered to apply for funding?

Q: How long does NPO funding take to approve?

Q: Can an individual apply for NPO funding, or do you need an organisation?

Important note for editor: This page likely also ranks for "SETA business funding" queries (12.6% CTR, pos 4.1). If so, add a brief H2 on SETA Skills Development grants for NPOs — a natural extension of the topic.

Internal links to add

- From </guide-government-funding-small-businesses/> (anchor: "NPO-specific funding")
- From </sme-funding/> category
- This article → CIPC registration article (NPOs must register as NPC with CIPC)
- This article → </non-profit-organisation-compliance-the-ins-and-outs/> (compliance context)

Success metrics (90 days)

- Target position: 5–8 (from 19.07)
 - Click target: 18,000–24,000/month (from 6,776)
-

Priority: MEDIUM — QUALITY SIGNAL | Type: Noindex / Rewrite / Consolidate | Est. effort: 1 hour dev + 1 day editor (for rewrites)

The off-brand pages listed below are attracting combined impressions of ~1.4M at near-zero CTR. They signal to Google that this site covers an unfocused range of topics, which contributes to the topicality signal problem underpinning the 87% traffic decline. This cleanup recovers signal quality — it won't immediately show in clicks but will improve domain-wide quality signals over 3-6 months.

5A — Paxi Page: SME Rewrite (Recommended)

URL: `/paxi-from-pep-logistics-to-partner-with-for-parcel-delivery/`

Current: 910,649 impressions, 1,046 clicks, 0.11% CTR, pos 8.77

Decision: REWRITE as an SME-specific guide. Do not noindex — 910K impressions represents genuine search volume from small business owners who want to use Paxi as a delivery solution. The current 0.11% CTR suggests the title and meta don't match SME delivery intent.

Rewrite spec:

- **SEO Title:** `How to Use Paxi as Your SME's Delivery Partner: Costs, Sign-Up & Tips (2026)`
- **Meta:** `Everything South African small business owners need to know about using Paxi from PEP for parcel delivery – signup, pricing, collection points and business account options.`
- **Focus keyphrase:** `paxi delivery for small business south africa`
- **Content:** Reframe entirely around the SME/seller use case. Include: how to sign up as a business sender, parcel size limits, pricing per parcel, collection point network, tracking, comparison with other courier options (Pudo, Courier Guy). Minimum 1,200 words.
- Add internal links to the Takealot seller article and courier comparison article.

5B — Takealot Seller Pages: Consolidation

Pages competing against each other:

URL	Impressions	Clicks	CTR	Position
/how-to-become-a-seller-on-takealot/	404,449	2,011	0.50%	7.91
/how-to-sell-on-takealot/	28,768	55	0.19%	18.82
[forum] How_can_I_successfully_start_selling_on_Takealot	34,033	30	0.09%	8.31

Action:

1. Keep: </how-to-become-a-seller-on-takealot/> (highest traffic, best position)
 2. Redirect: </how-to-sell-on-takealot/> → 301 → </how-to-become-a-seller-on-takealot/>
 3. Forum thread: add pinned link to the canonical article
 4. Refresh the canonical: reframe entirely as *"How South African SMEs Can Sell on Takealot"* — include seller portal registration, commission rates, fulfilment options, Takealot for Business programme.
 5. Yoast SEO Title: [How to Become a Seller on Takealot as an SME \(2026 Complete Guide\) | SME South Africa](#)
-

5C — Brands/Sage Page: Noindex

URL: </brands/sage/>

Current: 256,254 impressions, 245 clicks, 0.10% CTR, pos 10.89

Action: In Yoast → **Advanced** → **Robots Meta** → **noindex**. This is a brand partner/sponsor page that appears in search for Sage Accounting queries — it will never convert at meaningful rates and damages topicality signals.

Also check: if there are other [/brands/\[partner-name\]/](/brands/[partner-name]/) pages, apply the same treatment unless they have significant click volumes.

5D — Duplicate/Thin Funding Guides: Redirects

Already covered in Brief 2, but confirm these redirects are implemented:

- </sme-guides/guide-to-government-funding-for-small-businesses/> → 301 → </guide-government-funding-small-businesses/>
 - </sme-review/top-business-loans-for-small-businesses-in-south-africa/> (138K imp, pos 37.73) → audit content quality; if thin, either refresh or merge into </sme-guides/guide-to-business-loans/>
 - </6-types-of-business-loans-for-smes/> (92K imp, pos 38.49) → merge content into </sme-guides/guide-to-business-loans/> and redirect
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Phase 1 Link Architect Brief

For: Tshepho's Ops → Link Architect tool

Scope: 6 high-value orphan posts only — do NOT bulk-run all 274 orphans at this stage

The 274 orphan posts are all from 2014. Most are founder profile interviews with no ongoing search value — bulk-linking them into current content clusters would dilute the hub pages. Only the evergreen guide orphans with active ranking signals should be linked now.

Orphan posts to action (with link targets)

Orphan Post	URL slug	Current GSC position	Link FROM these pages	Suggested anchor text
Do You Need a Business Plan, Yes or No?	/business-plans-yes-or-no/	pos 1.0	Registration hub article; /sme-funding/ hub	"business plan"
8 Ways The Consumer Protection Act Affects You	/8-ways-consumer-protection-act-affects/	pos 6.0	/sme-guides/business-licences-in-south-africa/ (153K imp); registration hub "legal requirements" section	"Consumer Protection Act"
5 Laws Every Business Owner can't Afford to Ignore	/5-laws-every-business-owner-cant-afford-ignore/	pos 11.2	Registration hub "what to do after registration" section; /sme-guides/business-licences-in-south-africa/	"business laws"
Succession Planning: A Strategy for Your Business' Future Success	/succession-planning-strategy-business-future-success/	pos 5.6	/5-key-success-factors-of-businesses/ (145K imp, pos 11.7)	"succession planning"
Focus on The Black Business Suppliers Grant	/focus-black-business-suppliers-grant/	pos 9.5	/guide-government-funding-small-businesses/; /sme-funding/	"Black Business Suppliers Grant"
All Your E-commerce Questions Answered	/e-commerce-questions-answered/	pos 11.0	/how-to-become-a-seller-on-takealot/ (after refresh); /top-10-most-successful-businesses-to-start-in-south-africa/	"e-commerce questions"

Link Architect configuration notes

- Use Link Architect in bulk mode for these 6 posts only
- Set minimum link context: links should appear in body text, not footers or sidebars
- Target: 2-3 inbound links per orphan from contextually relevant pages

- After running: spot-check each linked post to ensure the anchor text reads naturally

What NOT to do with Link Architect at this stage

Do not run the full 274-post orphan list through Link Architect. The remaining 268 posts are 2014 founder profiles — many should be assessed for pruning/redirection before being linked into any hub. A content audit brief for those will follow in Phase 3.

Checklist: Phase 1 Completion Criteria

Before moving to Phase 2, confirm all of the following:

Developer tasks:

- ☐ /faqs-about-registering-a-company-in-south-africa/ → 301 redirect → registration article
- ☐ /sme-guides/guide-to-government-funding-for-small-businesses/ → 301 → /guide-government-funding-small-businesses/
- ☐ /how-to-sell-on-takealot/ → 301 → /how-to-become-a-seller-on-takealot/
- ☐ /brands/sage/ → Yoast → noindex
- ☐ Forum thread pinned notes added (registration, Getting Funding, Takealot)
- ☐ All redirected and refreshed URLs submitted via GSC → URL Inspection → Request Indexing

Editor tasks:

- ☐ Registration hub: full rewrite live (2,800–3,500 words, Yoast configured, HowTo schema added)
- ☐ /guide-government-funding-small-businesses/: full refresh live (2,200–2,800 words, FAQ schema)
- ☐ /sme-funding/ category: SEO description added in Yoast
- ☐ /10-cheapest-franchises/: refreshed with 2026 data, cost table, FAQ schema
- ☐ /non-profit-organisation-npo-funding/: refreshed (2,200–2,800 words)
- ☐ Paxi page: reframed as SME delivery guide
- ☐ Takealot seller article: reframed as SME seller guide
- ☐ All "last updated" dates visible and current on refreshed pages

Link Architect tasks:

- ☐ 6 orphan posts linked (see table above)
 - ☐ All 6 inbound link contexts reviewed for natural anchor text
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Phase 2 Preview — What Comes Next

Once Phase 1 is complete and GSC begins showing position improvements (typically 6–10 weeks), Phase 2 builds the remaining Business Advice/Guides hub:

1. **SARS/Tax for Small Business hub** — major 2026 threshold changes (VAT R2.3m, Turnover Tax R2.3m) make this timely and differentiating vs competitors still showing old R1m figures
2. **B-BBEE EME explainer** — high-intent, required for tender/funding eligibility
3. **Business plan template for South Africa** — seed from "Do You Need a Business Plan?" orphan (pos 1 with zero links — it will rank immediately once properly built out)
4. **Content audit + prune decision** for remaining 268 orphan 2014 posts — brief will classify each as: keep/refresh, redirect to relevant hub, or noindex/delete

Monthly GSC monitoring report template will accompany Phase 2 brief.